



Can Trump Make Venezuela An Oil Giant Again?

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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL **WEEKEND**



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DOW JONES | News Corp ***** SATURDAY/SUNDAY, JANUARY 10 - 11, 2026 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVII NO. 8 WSJ.com ★★★★★ \$6.00

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **American employers** added jobs at a subdued pace in December, capping a year in which the U.S. labor market lost considerable momentum. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump inadvertently** posted job-market statistics online Thursday night that were supposed to remain confidential until the next day, the White House said. **A2**
- ◆ **The S&P 500 and Dow** closed at record highs. For the week, the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq rose 1.6%, 2.3% and 1.9%, respectively. **B11**
- ◆ **Merck is in talks** to acquire Revolution Medicines in a deal that could value the cancer-drug biotech at about \$30 billion, according to people familiar with the matter. **B10**
- ◆ **Meta unveiled a series** of agreements that would make it an anchor customer for new and existing nuclear power in the U.S., where it needs city-size amounts of electricity for its AI centers. **B10**
- ◆ **China cemented** its global lead in electric vehicles in 2025 with local brands grabbing further share from foreign carmakers in the world's biggest car market. **B10**
- ◆ **Bob's Discount Furniture** has filed for its IPO. **B11**
- ◆ **Pandora's full-year sales** are set to come in below guidance after weak consumer sentiment in North America. **B11**

Worldwide

- ◆ **As Iranian protests** grow in size, an unlikely figure is gaining prominence—the son of the country's reviled shah, who was toppled in the nation's 1979 revolution. **A1**
- ◆ **Iran's supreme leader** said the Islamic Republic won't back down amid protests and threats from Trump to intervene. **A8**
- ◆ **Local prosecutors** in Minnesota are seeking evidence from the fatal shooting of a woman by an ICE agent as they weigh their next steps in response to the death. **A4**
- ◆ **Democrats in the New York** state legislature are pushing to require schools to teach students about the Jan. 6, 2021, attack on the U.S. Capitol, as the Trump administration sought to recast the riot as a "peaceful protest." **A3**
- ◆ **The U.S. Coast Guard** seized a fifth oil tanker and continued to eye other vessels trying to evade the U.S. blockade on sanctioned tankers traveling to and from Venezuela. **A6**
- ◆ **Russia launched** its nuclear-capable hypersonic Oreshnik missile against Ukraine for only the second time, hitting the western region of Lviv near the Polish border, in a significant escalation. **A8**
- ◆ **The EU approved** a trade deal with four South American countries, Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay and Uruguay. **A9**

NOONAN

A good riddance, but a disquieting one **A13**

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Job Gains Cool, Cap a Weak Year

Payrolls rose by 50,000 in December as unemployment ticked down to 4.4%

By HARRIET TORRY

U.S. employers added jobs at a subdued pace in December, capping a year in which the country's labor market lost considerable momentum. Outside of the two most recent recessions, 2025 saw the lowest pace of average monthly job growth since 2003. The U.S. economy added a

seasonally adjusted 50,000 jobs in December, the Labor Department said Friday. That was a slight slowdown from November's 56,000 gain and undershot economists' expectations for a 73,000 increase. The unemployment rate ticked down to 4.4% last month, although it has drifted up from 4% last January.

All told, employers added 584,000 new jobs in 2025—or about 49,000 jobs a month, on average. That is a marked deceleration from 2024, when the economy added two million jobs, at a pace of 168,000 a month.

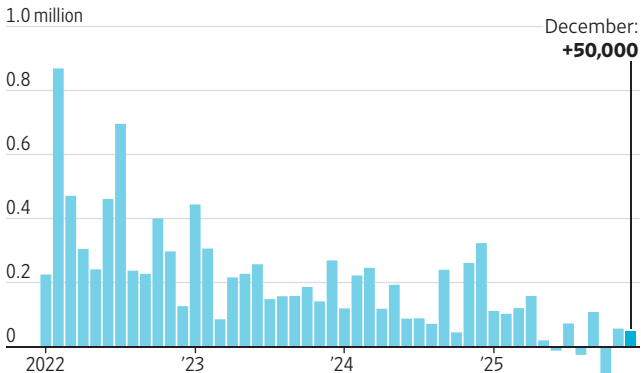
"We are at an inflection point," said U.S. Bank Chief Economist Beth Ann Bovino. Businesses that staffed up rapidly in the postpandemic years are pulling back on hiring, she said. Although economic growth has remained strong, with consumers and businesses continuing to spend, "the jobs market is very fragile—the unemployment rate is low, but businesses aren't hiring."

Headed into 2026, the labor

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◆ **Trump post indirectly revealed hiring stats..... A2**

Nonfarm payrolls, change from a month earlier



Note: Seasonally adjusted. November and December 2025 are preliminary. Source: Labor Department

As Turmoil Rocks Tehran, Regime Vows Crackdown



DEFIANCE: Iranians chant 'Death to the dictator' as they march in the capital, in an image from video. Supreme Leader Ali Khamenei said Friday Iran 'will not retreat' after President Trump threatened to intervene if the regime response turns deadly. **A8**

Iran Protesters Rally Behind Son Of Former Shah as Unrest Grows

By BENOIT FAUCON AND MARGHERITA STANCATI

As Iranian protests grow in size, an unlikely figure is gaining prominence—the son of the country's reviled shah, who was toppled in the 1979 revolution. Iranians across the country are chanting slogans in support of Reza Pahlavi, whose father, Mohammed Reza Pahlavi, ruled the country for decades. The chants come as the

tone of the protests, which began with outrage over a falling currency and soaring prices, is shifting from economic concerns to attacks on the legitimacy of the theocratic regime itself. Protesters shouting anti-regime slogans filled streets in Tehran on Thursday night in the largest demonstrations in years. Videos showed burned out cars and a mosque. "Long live the Shah," shouted protesters in a shop-

ping center in Tehran, as others set fire to a nearby government building, according to a video verified by Storyful, which is owned by Wall Street Journal parent News Corp.

"This is the last battle," thousands chanted at another march elsewhere in the capital, adding, "Pahlavi will return."

The 65-year-old Pahlavi's prominence is a departure from previous bouts of protest, when the heir of the

controversial dynasty was rarely evoked. His father, who ruled Iran from the 1940s, was widely despised in Iran for his autocratic rule, his political repression and what critics saw as his subservience to the U.S.

Few analysts think Pahlavi has a real path to the throne or leadership in Iran. His improved reputation in recent years says more about the

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President Blindsides Housing Investors

Blackstone Chief Executive Officer Stephen Schwarzman helped launch Wall Street into the business of buying and renting out single-family homes in the aftermath of the 2008 housing crash.

By Ryan Dezimmer, Miriam Gottfried and Josh Dawsey

This past week, his firm and others across the industry were blindsided when President Trump—a property mogul himself who many in the sector consider an ally—said he plans to boot investors from the market.

Though they regained some ground later in the week, shares of the two big publicly traded single-family landlords, Invitation Homes and AMH, shed 6% and 4.3%, respectively, on Wednesday.

Shares of Blackstone were hit, too. The firm financed the creation of Invitation Homes but has since sold all its stock. It now owns smaller rival Tricon Residential. The 5.6% decline in Blackstone's shares Wednesday cut the value of Schwarzman's roughly 20% stake by more than \$2.1 billion. Shares have recovered some since.

A Blackstone spokesman said the firm's ownership of U.S. single-family homes represents about 2% of its real-estate assets under management and 0.5% of the firm's overall assets.

Trump's top advisers have pushed the president to change his messaging on the economy

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EXCHANGE



DISNEY MAGIC
Inside the secret team working on the next big thing. **B1**

Trump's Fixation With Foreign Oil

Venezuela is latest example of wanting to leverage military might for energy

By ANNIE LINSKEY AND COLLIN EATON

WASHINGTON—A smooth-faced 41-year-old Donald Trump settled in before a live studio audience assembled for "The Oprah Winfrey Show" and held forth on how America should be getting a cut of Kuwaiti oil.

"Kuwait is not paying us for all the oil they're sending out," said Trump, wearing a familiar solid red tie, as Oprah pressed him on his foreign policy views during the April 1988 interview. He complained that the Kuwaitis "live like kings" while the American military protected their tankers amid

the Iraq-Iran War.

"Why aren't they paying us 25% of what they're making?" Trump asked.

In media interviews going back to the 1980s—long before he would dominate U.S. politics—Trump outlined his interest in the U.S. seizing oil from countries where Americans intervened. Now, in his second term, he's making an audacious bid to turn his decadeslong fixation

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- ◆ **U.S. seizes fifth tanker of campaign..... A6**
- ◆ **Trump presses oil executives to invest in Venezuela..... A6**
- ◆ **Heard on the Street: \$50 oil price goal is doable..... B12**